Resume & Interview Checklist

For MBA graduates and career switchers. Tick each box as you go.

Part 1: Resume checklist

Format

- [ ] One page if you have under 10 years of experience; two pages at most.
- [ ] One clean font (10 to 11 pt), consistent dates and spacing.
- [ ] Saved as a PDF and named FirstName_LastName_Resume.
- [ ] Contact line has a phone number, a professional email and a LinkedIn link that works.

Top of the page

- [ ] A headline with your target role, for example: Marketing Manager | MBA.
- [ ] A 2 to 3 line summary written for this role, not for every role.
- [ ] A skills section that uses words from the job description, only for skills you can back up.

Experience and achievements

- [ ] Most recent role first.
- [ ] Each bullet follows: action verb + what you did + the result, with numbers where honest.
- [ ] Duty-only bullets (“responsible for…”) are cut or rewritten.
- [ ] Tense is consistent: past tense for past roles.
- [ ] Internships, projects and live work are included if they show relevant skills.

If you are switching careers

- [ ] Past work is translated into skills the new role needs (for example, “managed vendors” becomes negotiation and stakeholder management).
- [ ] One project, course or certification proves you can do the new work.
- [ ] Your summary says in one line why you are switching.

Final checks

- [ ] You read it aloud, and one other person read it too.
- [ ] Spelling, links and phone number are checked.
- [ ] Your LinkedIn profile matches your resume.
- [ ] For each application, you changed the summary and the top three bullets to fit the role.

Part 2: Interview checklist

Before the interview

- [ ] Read the job description and highlight the top five requirements.
- [ ] Research the company: what it sells, who its customers are, and one recent news item.
- [ ] Prepare four short stories using STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result): a result you drove, a failure, a conflict, a leadership moment.
- [ ] Rehearse a 60 to 90 second “Tell me about yourself.”
- [ ] Prepare three questions to ask them.
- [ ] Test your link, camera and audio, or plan your route and arrive early.

During the interview

- [ ] Listen to the whole question and pause before you answer.
- [ ] Structure answers with STAR and finish with the result.
- [ ] Use numbers when you can, and be honest about gaps.
- [ ] Ask a clarifying question if you are unsure what they want.
- [ ] Close by saying why you want this role.

After the interview

- [ ] Send a short thank-you email within 24 hours.
- [ ] Write down the questions you were asked and how each answer went.
- [ ] Follow up politely if you have not heard back by the date they gave.

Career-switch pitch (fill in the blanks)

> “I have ___ years in ___, where I ___ (result). I am moving into ___ because ___. My ___ skills and ___ (project or certification) prepare me for this role.”

Questions to practise

- [ ] Tell me about yourself.
- [ ] Why this role, and why now?
- [ ] Why are you switching from ___ to ___?
- [ ] Tell me about a time you failed.
- [ ] Describe a disagreement with a colleague and how you handled it.
- [ ] Where do you want to be in five years?

Free resource for general guidance only. It does not guarantee any job outcome.